

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/24: The controlling question, the definition and the inheritance

SYLLABUS ITEM 17, PRINTED VERBATIM: "Yoga; Citta; Cittavṛtti; Klesas; Samadhi; Kaivalya."
normalised: Yoga · citta · citta-vṛtti · kleśa · samādhi · kaivalya

CONTROLLING QUESTION how does a mind stop handing the witness something to be?

+---- THE DEFINITION AND ITS TWO COMPANIONS (Yoga-sūtra 1.2 - 1.4) -----+
| 1.2 yogaś-citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ Yoga = restraint of the modifications of the |
| mind-field. A STATE, not an activity. |
| 1.3 tadā draṣṭuḥ svarūpe'vasthānam . then the seer abides in its own nature. |
| 1.4 otherwise the seer takes the FORM of the modifications |
| => this is what bondage IS. |
+-----+

WHAT IS INHERITED (Sāṃkhya owns; Yoga restates only what its psychology needs)
many conscious witnesses (puruṣa) · one primordial material nature (prakṛti)
three constituent qualities (guṇa) · twenty-five principles (tattva)
effect pre-exists in cause (satkāryavāda) · real transformation (pariṇāmavāda)
bondage = non-discrimination · release = discriminative knowledge

WHAT YOGA OWNS (this is the answerable syllabus item)
mind-field psychology · five modifications · afflicted / unafflicted division
practice + dispassion · five afflictions · moral causation of action · eight limbs
absorption taxonomies · combined discipline · the Lord · discriminative discernment
cloud-of-dharma absorption · isolation

THE PUBLIC SIGNATURE

Sāṃkhya = nirīśvara (Godless) Yoga = seśvara-sāṃkhya (theistic Sāṃkhya)
also called sāṃkhya-pravacana (Sāṃkhya-exposition)

+-----+
| ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE |
| Yoga does not add a new world to Sāṃkhya's world; it adds a discipline to |
| Sāṃkhya's argument – which is why its definition is a psychological state and |
| not a metaphysical thesis. |
+-----+

! TRAP 1: do not define Yoga as union with God. Patañjali defines it by cessation.
! TRAP 2: do not write that Yoga rejects Sāṃkhya. It operationalises Sāṃkhya.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/24: Textual identity, the four chapters and source control

PATAÑJALI, YOGA-SŪTRA – four chapters (pāda), each with a centre of gravity

1. SAMĀDHI-PĀDA (absorption)	definition · five modifications · practice and dispassion · the Lord · object-supported and seedless absorption
2. SĀDHANA-PĀDA (practice)	preparatory discipline · five afflictions and four states · action, deposit, fruition · the seen and the seer · the eight limbs
3. VIBHŪTI-PĀDA (powers)	combined discipline (dhāraṇā + dhyāna + samādhi) · three transformations of the mind · extraordinary capacities AND their demotion
4. KAIVALYA-PĀDA (isolation)	mind / object realism against idealism · latent tendencies · discriminative knowledge · cloud-of-dharma absorption · involution of the qualities · isolation

THE READING TRADITION (the operative form in which the system is taught)

Vyāsa, YOGA-BHĀṢYA → Vācaspati Miśra, TATTVAVAIŚĀRADĪ → Vijñānabhikṣu,
YOGAVĀRTTIKA

+---- SOURCE-CONTROL LEDGER – label the layer you are quoting -----+		
	COMMENTARIAL, NOT A SŪTRA LIST	WHY IT MATTERS
	the five mind-levels (citta-bhūmi)	usable, incl. for the 2019 paper; attribute
		to Vyāsa-onward exposition, not to Patañjali
	the four stages of lower dispassion	Patañjali's own definition (1.15) is mastery
	(yatamāna, vyatireka, ekendriya,	over thirst for seen and heard-of objects
	vaśīkāra)	
	the expanded theoretical proof-set	Patañjali's grounds are compact and
	for the Lord	practice-facing; do not project later proofs
+-----+		

! TRAP 3: the historical layering and dating of the sūtra tradition are DISPUTED.
Identify the received Pātañjala system; never build an answer on a date.

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE: the Yoga-sūtra is a text of headings and the tradition that reads
it is a text of paragraphs; a Yoga answer earns authority by never confusing the two.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/24: The mind-field – constitution, derivation and contrasts

PRIMORDIAL MATERIAL NATURE (prakṛti)

| evolution

v

DETERMINATIVE INTELLECT (buddhi / mahat)

|

v

EGO-MAKER (ahaṁkāra)

| from its LUCID (sattva-predominant) side only

v

SENSORY MIND (manas)

ALL THREE TAKEN TOGETHER AS ONE OPERATIVE CONTINUUM = THE MIND-FIELD (citta)

COMPONENT	ROLE	WHY YOGA FILES IT UNDER citta
-----	-----	-----
buddhi (intellect)	ascertainment, decision	discrimination and resolve here
ahaṁkāra (ego-maker)	appropriation as "I"	ownership and doership arise here
manas (sensory mind)	co-ordination, doubt	sense-data received and arranged

NATURE OF THE MIND-FIELD

a product of prakṛti => jaḍa (insentient) in itself
lucid-predominant as a WORKING WHOLE => transparent, able to take object-form
and to mirror consciousness
therefore: the PSYCHICAL INSTRUMENT of experience, NOT the self

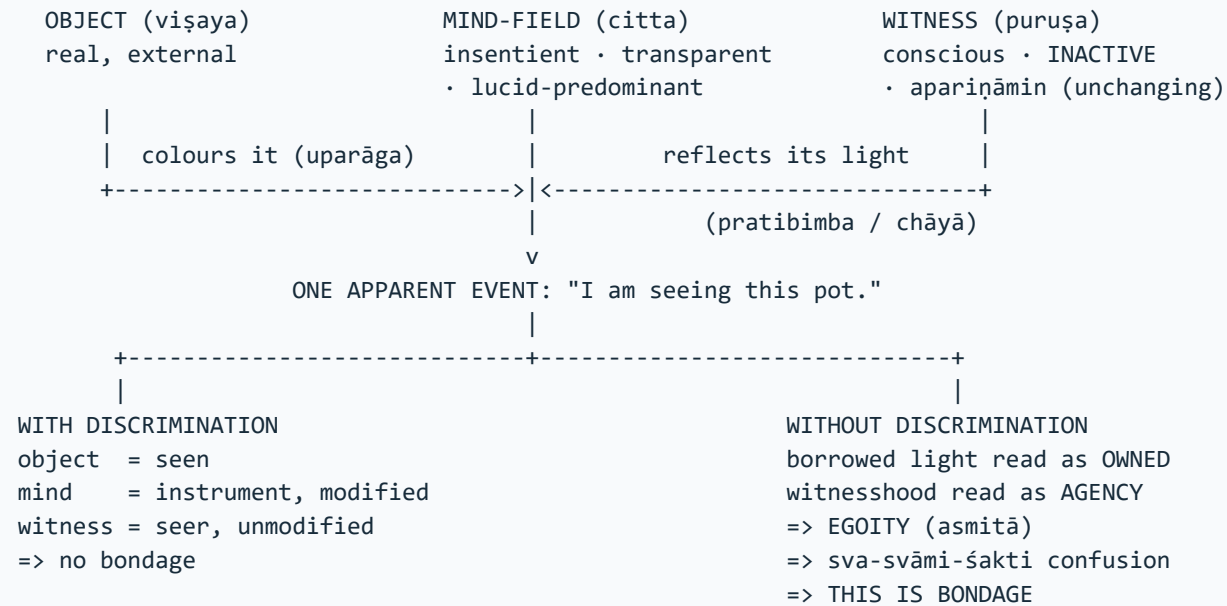
! TRAP 4: only manas derives DIRECTLY from lucid ahaṁkāra. Sattva-predominance is a property of the whole; it is not a derivation of intellect and ego from lucid ego.

CONTRAST GRID

SCHOOL	INTERNAL ORGAN	KEY DIFFERENCE FROM YOGA
-----	-----	-----
Sāṃkhya	buddhi / ahaṁkāra / manas kept analytically distinct	Yoga gathers them functionally into one field
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	manas: atomic, partless internal sense + a separate self-substance	Yoga's citta is broad, composite, transformable
Advaita Vedānta	antaḥkaraṇa under avidyā within a Brahman framework	Yoga keeps many puruṣas and has NO Brahman doctrine

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE: gathering intellect, ego and sense-mind under one name is a claim that bondage is suffered by the WHOLE interior and cannot be cured faculty by faculty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/24: Reflection, mere proximity and the birth of egoity



THE PROTECTED CLAIM

relation = SANNIDHI-MĀTRA (mere proximity). ALL transformation is on the mind's side.
the witness neither acts nor changes. Bondage is phenomenological and epistemic.

IMAGES THAT DO THE WORK

sphaṭika (clear crystal) beside a red flower -> looks red; neither is altered
magnet and iron -> mere presence moves the iron

OBJECTION -> reflection normally presupposes a REAL relation between mirror and original;
ontologically disjoint principles have none.

REPLY -> all change is on the citta side; the witness is untouched.

RESIDUE ! -> mere proximity NAMES the relation more clearly than it EXPLAINS it.
Advaita presses by collapsing the duality; Nyāya by making consciousness an adventitious property of a substantial self.

2024 ANCHOR: "So long as there are changes and modifications in citta, the self is reflected therein, and, in the absence of discriminative knowledge, identifies itself with them." -> this panel IS that question.

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE: bondage is devastating in experience and unreal in metaphysics –
the mirror is in trouble; the lamp never was.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/24: The five levels of the mind-field and the 2019 application

LEVEL (citta-bhūmi)	RULING QUALITY	CHARACTER	FIT FOR YOGA?
kṣipta (scattered)	rajas (active)	runs object to object; activity without integration	NO pre-yogic
mūḍha (dull)	tamas (inert)	torpor, delusion, inertia: OBSCURATION, not calm	NO pre-yogic
vikṣipta (distracted)	mixed, occasional sattva flashes	attends, infers, analyses, briefly concentrates; cannot remain inwardly collected	NO only partly prepared
ekāgra (one-pointed)	sattva (lucid)	sustained one-pointedness on a chosen support	YES yoga-fit
niruddha (restrained)	modifications arrested	consummation of disciplined inwardness; NOT blankness	YES culmination

kṣipta -> mūḍha -> vikṣipta ==||== ekāgra -> niruddha
||

THE DECISIVE STEP: occasional concentration
becomes SUSTAINED one-pointedness

2019 APPLIED READING (Q7(b), 15 marks – "justify your answer")

SCIENTIST vikṣipta. Intense but OUTWARD-directed, result-attached,
interrupted. High intellectual focus is NOT yogic restraint.

GOD-REALISED DEVOTEE .. ekāgra. Lucid-dominant mind on a single support; dedication
to the Lord stabilises the field and removes the obstacles.

SELF-REALISED YOGIN ... niruddha. Modifications stilled; correlated with the highest
absorption and the approach to isolation.

! TRAP 5: the criterion is RULING QUALITY and stability of inward collection, never the
force of attention. A distracted genius sits below a one-pointed devotee.

! TRAP 6: the fivefold scheme is Vyāsa-onward commentarial exposition, not a sūtra list.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/24: The five modifications and the afflicted / unafflicted cut

ALL MENTAL EVENTS = FIVE MODIFICATIONS (citta-vṛtti) – claimed EXHAUSTIVE

pramāṇa (valid cognition)	cognition via perception, inference, authoritative testimony	smoke seen -> fire correctly inferred
viparyaya (error)	false cognition not matching the object as it is	nacre taken for silver
vikalpa (verbal construction)	cognition from WORDS ALONE with no corresponding object	"the horn of a hare"; intelligible without referent
nidrā (sleep)	a POSITIVE mode grounded on absence-content	waking report: "I slept and knew nothing"
smṛti (memory)	non-loss and re-presentation of experienced content	recollection of past pain or pleasure

EACH OF THE FIVE SPLITS ORTHOGONALLY

+-----+	+-----+
v	v
KLIṢṬA (afflicted)	AKLIṢṬA (unafflicted)
coloured by avidyā and the other afflictions; bondage-producing e.g. memory feeding a grievance testimony used for vanity	purified, redirected toward discrimination and detachment e.g. valid cognition of impermanence

THE LADDER RULE

unafflicted modifications CANCEL afflicted ones and then THEMSELVES SUBSIDE.
a ladder is climbed and left behind; it is not carried to the top floor.

WHY VALID COGNITION IS ON THE LIST

what binds the seer is not the FALSITY of a mental form but the fact that it is a FORM.
Yoga accepts three instruments of knowledge; it simply denies that truth exempts a
mental form from being a mental form.

- ! TRAP 7: the kliṣṭa / akliṣṭa division qualifies MODIFICATIONS only. Afflictions are inherently afflictive; there is no "unafflicted ignorance".
- ! TRAP 8: sleep is a modification, not the absence of modification, and not liberation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/24: Why cessation is prescribed, and the epistemology that limits it

THE FIVE-STEP DERIVATION (this is the 2023 "give reasons" answer, numbered)

STEP 1 the mind-field takes the FORM of whatever it attends to

|

STEP 2 the witness's consciousness is REFLECTED in that form

|

STEP 3 in ignorance the changing form is APPROPRIATED in the first person:

"I know" · "I suffer" · "I desire" · "I remember"

|

STEP 4 therefore the stream of modifications SUSTAINS bondage –
it is the running MECHANISM, not a symptom

|

STEP 5 therefore restraint UNCOVERS the already-free seer

+-----+
| NIRODHA IS REVELATORY, NOT DESTRUCTIVE: it removes concealment, not consciousness. |
| IMAGE: when ripples settle, the pool reflects one clear sky. Nothing was added to |
| the water and nothing was taken from the sky. |
+-----+

EPISTEMOLOGY IN THE SAME FRAME – THE SCHOOL POLICING ITS OWN ENTHUSIASM

THREE INSTRUMENTS ADMITTED

pratyakṣa (perception)

anumāna (inference)

āgama / śabda (testimony)

WHAT IS NOT ADDED

NO fourth instrument for yogic insight

truth-bearing insight = PERFECTED PERCEPTION

(yogi-pratyakṣa), and it is STILL a modification,
so it too must finally cease

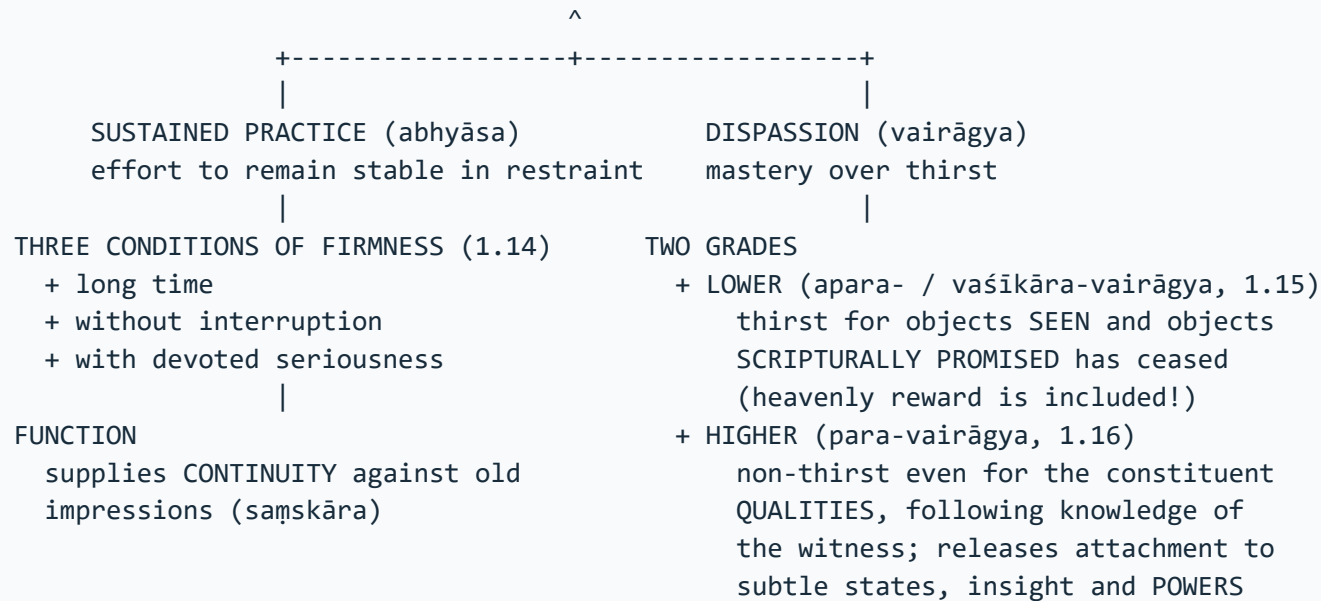
count check: Yoga 3 · Sāṃkhya 3 · Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika 4 · Buddhist epistemologists 2
· Advaita commonly 6

! TRAP 9: do not give Yoga four or six instruments, and do not promote ṛtambharā prajñā
into an independent means of knowledge.

! TRAP 10: restraint is not the destruction of the mind as a substance.

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE: Yoga prescribes cessation not because thought is bad but because
thought is the running machinery of a mistake.

RESTRAINT OF THE MODIFICATIONS



JOINT RESPONSIBILITY (1.12): neither repetition without detachment nor detachment without stabilised practice is sufficient.

FAILURE MODES

practice without dispassion strain, tug-of-war, relapse
dispassion without practice mood without capacity

COMMENTARIAL LADDER INSIDE LOWER DISPASSION – label it as commentarial	
yatamāna	effort toward control
vyatireka	separation of subdued from unsubdued tendencies
ekendriya	withdrawal to a single residual mental desire
vaśīkāra	mastery

! TRAP 11: higher dispassion is discernment-generated non-thirst, NOT apathy, boredom or world-hatred; and it is not merely a stronger grade of the lower.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/24: Real transformation of the mind-substrate

GENERAL FRAME – any substrate of nature

+-----+	
PERSISTING SUBSTRATE (dharmin)	
dharma-pariṇāma change of PROPERTY	
lakṣaṇa-pariṇāma change of TEMPORAL PHASE (past / present / future)	
avasthā-pariṇāma change of CONDITION (intensity, maturity)	
+-----+	

THE THREE SPECIFICALLY YOGIC TRANSFORMATIONS OF THE MIND (Vibhūti-pāda)

nirodha-pariṇāma (restraint-transformation)	impressions of RESTRAINT progressively overpower impressions of emergence; the mind becomes habituated to cessation rather than to dispersion

samādhi-pariṇāma (absorption-transformation)	many-pointedness declines and unified absorption rises; distracting multiplicity weakens as one object dominates

ekāgratā-pariṇāma (one-pointedness- transformation)	similar cognitive moments arise and subside in an UNBROKEN STREAM toward the same object (even the highest stability is a stream, not a freeze)

WHY A BEARER IS NEEDED: practice ACCUMULATES · impressions are DEPOSITED and RETRIEVED
· a practitioner ACQUIRES a stable capacity. None of these is a
feature of a mere succession.

IMAGE: one lake – stormy, then calming, then still. Three states, one lake.

THE CONTESTED JOINT

- | | |
|-----------------------|---|
| Buddhist kṣaṇikavādin | -> a stream of momentary events suffices; the substrate is an unnecessary fiction |
| Yoga's reply | -> graded discipline, memory and impression-continuity need more than disconnected flashes |
| RESIDUE ! | -> a sufficiently rich causal series may reproduce much of what Yoga assigns to a substrate |
| Advaita vivartavāda | -> change is only APPARENT; Yoga insists the change is REAL |

! TRAP 12: the persisting citta is a substrate of NATURE, not a self. The witness stands outside every one of these transformations.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/24: The five afflictions, the four reversals and the four states

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+---- IGNORANCE (avidyā) – THE ROOT, not merely the first item -----+
|  FOUR REVERSALS (each separately markable)                             |
|    non-eternal  -> taken as ->  eternal                               |
|    impure       -> taken as ->  pure                                   |
|    painful      -> taken as ->  pleasant                             |
|    non-self     -> taken as ->  self                                  |
+-----+

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| is the FIELD in which the other four grow

+-----+-----+-----+-----+			
v	v	v	v
ASMITĀ (egoity)	RĀGA (attachment)	DVEṢA (aversion)	ABHINIVEŚA (clinging to life) instinctive
seer identified with the	pursuit following	flight following	self-preservation,
INSTRUMENT of seeing	remembered PLEASURE	remembered PAIN	PRESENT EVEN IN THE
-> "I think, I act, I suffer"			LEARNED

FOUR STATES OF ANY AFFLICTION

-----	-----	-----
prasupta	dormant	seed-like, not presently manifest; DORMANCY IS NOT
		DESTRUCTION – favourable conditions reactivate it
-----	-----	-----
tanu	attenuated	thinned by practice, austerity, meditation, discernment;
		the only state that represents genuine progress
-----	-----	-----
vicchinna	interrupted	temporarily overridden by an opposing tendency –
		attachment may look absent only because fear is louder
-----	-----	-----
udāra	fully active	visibly governing speech, action and affect

DIAGNOSTIC RULE: "I no longer feel it" is compatible with dormant, attenuated AND interrupted. Only destruction of the seed removes an affliction.

THERAPY LADDER: gross expression -> ethical and practical discipline
 subtle form (sūkṣma) -> dhyāna burns it
 the seed -> discriminative discernment destroys it

! TRAP 13: do not list five PARALLEL afflictions. Ignorance is the root of the other four.
 ! TRAP 14: abhiniveśa survives learning; it is not an intellectual error.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/24: The engine of bondage – chain, carriers and action-colours

AFFLICTIONS (kleśa)

| motivate

v

ACTION (karma)

| deposits

v

KARMIC DEPOSIT (karmāśaya) kleśa-mūla: rooted in the afflictions

| ripens as

v

FRUITION (vipāka), THREEFOLD: jāti (birth / species-condition)

āyus (life-span)

bhoga (experience: enjoyment and suffering)

| generates fresh reaction

v

REBIRTH (punarjanma) -----> loop closes and runs again

CARRIED BY: saṃskāra (impression) and vāsanā (latent tendency) – cognition and action
leave traces; traces dispose future cognition and action; the cycle becomes
MORALLY STRUCTURED rather than merely repetitive.

FOUR COLOURS OF ACTION

śukla (white) meritorious

kṛṣṇa (black) demeritorious

śukla-kṛṣṇa (mixed) the ordinary human mixture

aśukla-akṛṣṇa (neither) the practitioner whose action no longer produces
ordinary bondage

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/24: Jamming the engine – preparatory discipline and the burnt seed

WHERE THE ENGINE IS JAMMED

- (1) AT THE ROOT – PREPARATORY DISCIPLINE (kriyā-yoga), stated purpose: attenuate the afflictions (tanū-karaṇa) and cultivate absorption
tapas disciplined, heat-generating effort
svādhyāya study and recitation of sacred teaching + self-examination
īśvara-praṇidhāna . surrender of the fruits and of the ego's proprietary claim
(also a niyama AND an independent means to absorption)
- (2) AT THE SEED – dhyāna burns subtle forms; viveka-khyāti destroys the seed;
pratiprasava reabsorbs the residue

OBJECTION -> if release requires exhausting an unsurveyable stock of deposit, release is indefinitely postponed.

REPLY -> liberating knowledge and absorption burn the seeds of FUTURE bondage.
dagdha-bīja (burnt seed) keeps its shape; cannot germinate
potter's wheel after the push stops the wheel turns until momentum is spent = residual embodiment WITHOUT fresh bondage

! TRAP 15: fruition is THREEFOLD. Writing "vipāka" as a single item loses the precision.

! TRAP 16: kriyā-yoga (3 items) is NOT saṃyama (limbs 6-8) and NOT the eight limbs.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/24: The eight-limbed discipline – the five external limbs

EXTERNAL LIMBS (bahiraṅga) – preparatory with respect to subtler operations

- | | | |
|---|-------------------------|--|
| 1 | YAMA (restraints) | ahimsā (non-violence) · satya (truthfulness)
· asteya (non-stealing) · brahmacarya (disciplined
continence) · aparigraha (non-possessiveness)
YS 2.31: unrestricted by birth/class, place, time or
circumstance => SĀRVABHAUMA-MAHĀVRATA, the universal great
vow. No exceptional context licenses violence or falsehood. |
| 2 | NIYAMA (observances) | śauca (purity) · santoṣa (contentment) · tapas (austerity)
· svādhyāya (self-study) · īśvara-praṇidhāna (dedication)
NOTE the overlap with kriyā-yoga in the last three. |
| 3 | ĀSANA (posture) | a STEADY and COMFORTABLE seat; freedom from bodily
distraction, not gymnastic display |
| 4 | PRĀṆĀYĀMA (breath) | regulation of breath and the psycho-physical economy;
breath is the hinge between body and mind |
| 5 | PRATYĀHĀRA (withdrawal) | senses released from compulsive extroversion; the BRIDGE
into explicitly internal work |

=====

INTERNAL LIMBS (antaraṅga) – graded, NOT synonymous

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6	DHĀRAṆĀ (concentration)	binding citta to ONE chosen locus; first clear sign of one-pointedness (ekāgratā)
--	-----	-----
7	DHYĀNA (meditation)	UNINTERRUPTED FLOW of cognition toward that same object; also the burner of subtle afflictions
--	-----	-----
8	SAMĀDHI (absorption)	the object alone shines; discursiveness recedes

6 + 7 + 8 APPLIED TO ONE OBJECT = SAMYAMA (combined discipline)

NINE OBSTACLES (antarāya): vyādhi (disease) · styāna (mental stagnation) · saṃśaya (doubt) · pramāda (carelessness) · ālasya (laziness) · avirati (sensual non-restraint) · bhrānti-darśana (false vision) · alabdha-bhūmikatva (failure to attain a stage) · anavasthitatva (instability in an attained stage)

FOUR SYMPTOMS: duḥkha (suffering) · daurmanasya (dejection) · aṅgamejayatva (bodily tremor) · śvāsa-praśvāsa (disturbed inhalation and exhalation)

REMEDIES: īśvara-praṇidhāna · practice of ONE principle · friendliness, compassion, gladness and equanimity · breath regulation · suitable meditative supports

=> THIS is why questions on samādhi open into the role of God: Yoga's God is a PRACTICE-ENABLING doctrine, not a creation-first one.

! TRAP 17: "external" means PREPARATORY, not unimportant. Yoga's answer to "is dhyāna enough without ethics?" is NO: meditative power can coexist with affliction and egoity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/24: Absorption – the two grids that must not be conflated

OBJECT-SUPPORTED ABSORPTION (samprajñāta) = WITH SEED (sabīja, YS 1.46)

+---- GRID A – YS 1.17: WHICH FACTOR ACCOMPANIES THE ABSORPTION -----+

	vitarka	gross object-level deliberative grasp	
	vicāra	subtle object-level reflection	
	ānanda	refined LUCID joy – NOT ordinary pleasure	
	asmitā	bare I-am-ness – NOT the binding affliction, but an extremely subtle	
		objectification of the I-sense	
	=>	ānanda and asmitā are NOT a contested later addition; they are IN the sūtra.	

+-----+

+---- GRID B – YS 1.42-1.44: COALESCENCE (samāpatti) BY OBJECT AND OVERLAY -----+

	savitarkā	gross (sthūla) object · mixed with śabda-artha-jñāna-vikalpa	
	nirvitarkā	gross object · memory and verbal construction purified	
	savicārā	subtle (sūkṣma) object · subtle reflective consideration remains	
	nirvicārā	subtle object · even subtle reflective overlay stilled	
	YS 1.45	extends the subtle domain up to the undifferentiated (aliṅga)	
	YS 1.46	declares ALL of these sabīja	

+-----+

GRID A asks: WHAT ACCOMPANIES IT? GRID B asks: WHAT IS IT ON, AND HOW CLEAN?

commentators MAP the two grids; they do NOT IDENTIFY them.

example: the crystal takes the colour of the flower – citta becomes so object-coloured that the object seems to shine through it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/24: Absorption – seed senses, residue and the two routes

THE MOVE BEYOND

- YS 1.47 vaiśāradya (clarity) of nirvicārā -> adhyātma-prasāda (inner clarity)
- YS 1.48 therein the insight is ṛtambharā (truth-bearing)
- YS 1.18 ASAMPRAJÑĀTA: preceded by virāma-pratyaya (practice of the idea of cessation) AND having SAṂSKĀRA-ŚEṢA (impression-residue)
- YS 1.51 when THAT TOO is restrained, everything being restrained => NIRBĪJA

TWO SENSES OF "SEED" – THE TERMINOLOGY TRAP

- sabīja (1.46) = with OBJECT-SUPPORT
- nirbīja (1.51) = without the residual IMPRESSION
- => losing the object-support does NOT by itself make an absorption seedless.
- SAFE FORMULA: asamprajñāta = vṛttis stopped, saṁskāra-śeṣa remains;
nirbīja = even that residue restrained.

TWO ROUTES (bases, NOT a third classification)

- YS 1.19 bhava-pratyaya .. condition-based; videha / prakṛti-laya beings.
Commentators warn: nature-mergence need not equal final
discriminative isolation.
- YS 1.20 upāya-pratyaya .. means-based; śraddhā · vīrya · smṛti · samādhi · prajñā

! TRAP 18: NEVER write "the four types of samprajñāta given by Patañjali are savitarka, nirvitarka, savicāra and nirvicāra."

! TRAP 19: asamprajñāta is not sleep – nidrā is itself one of the five modifications.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 17/24: Truth-bearing insight, seedlessness and the cloud of dharma

nirvicārā coalescence perfected
| its clarity (vaiśāradya)

v

ADHYĀTMA-PRASĀDA – inner clarity of the self-field [YS 1.47]

|

v

+---- ṚTAMBHARĀ PRAJÑĀ – TRUTH-BEARING INSIGHT ----- [YS 1.48] ----+

| FIELD a PARTICULAR object (viśeṣa-artha) |
| CONTRAST ... śruta (testimony) and anumāna (inference) reach universals and |
| general relations; this reaches the individual |
| STATUS NOT a fourth pramāṇa. Yoga admits three. Best classified as perfected |
| extraordinary yogic perception (yogi-pratyakṣa) |
| FUNCTION ... its saṃskāra OBSTRUCTS other saṃskāras [YS 1.50] |
| OBJECTION .. if it is still a vṛtti, how can it help rather than bind? |
| REPLY akliṣṭa cancels kliṣṭa, then itself ceases. A LADDER, left behind. |
| CAUTION ! .. do NOT equate it with later "knowledge by identity" or supermind; |
| the resemblance is thematic only. Here it must finally CEASE. |

+-----+

| and then it too must cease

v

NIRBĪJA SAMĀDHI – seedless absorption [YS 1.51]

|

v

DHARMAMEGHA-SAMĀDHI – the cloud of dharma rains down the fullness of discriminative knowledge; even FASCINATION with extraordinary knowledge or power is relinquished. The yogin no longer seeks omniscience, attainment or display.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 18/24: Extraordinary capacities – attainments and obstacles

THE SIDE-BRANCH: EXTRAORDINARY CAPACITIES

saṁyama (combined discipline) -> siddhi (extraordinary capacities)

YS 3.37: attainments in the OUTWARD-TURNED state, but SAMĀDHĀV UPASARGĀḤ –
OBSTACLES TO ABSORPTION when they attract appropriation

WHY: they reactivate egoity, attachment and pride

STATUS: side-effects of discipline, NOT the essence of isolation

GOVERNOR: para-vairāgya (higher dispassion) releases attachment to subtle states,
knowledge and powers

! TRAP 20: reporting the capacities is doctrinal exposition, not empirical endorsement.
Say the text owns and subordinates them; do not certify them as verified fact.

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE: the most disciplined thing about Yoga is what it says about its
own successes – the highest insight is a ladder and the powers are obstacles.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 19/24: The Lord – definition, roles, negations and source control

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+---- WHAT HE IS -----+
|  ĪŚVARA = PURUṢA-VIŚEṢA, a SPECIAL conscious witness          [YS 1.24] |
|    untouched by kleśa (affliction) · karma (action) · vipāka (fruition) |
|    · āśaya (karmic deposit)                                         |
|  in him lies the UNSURPASSED SEED OF OMNISCIENCE                    [YS 1.25] |
|  TEACHER OF THE ANCIENTS, not limited by time                      [YS 1.26] |
|  denoted by PRANAVA (OM)                                           [YS 1.27] |
|  practice: repetition of it WITH CONTEMPLATION OF ITS MEANING      [YS 1.28] |
|  SPECIAL, not different in kind: he belongs to the category of witness; his |
|  distinction is that he was NEVER ENTANGLED.                       |
+-----+
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WHAT HE DOES (five roles)

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object of meditation -> one-pointed
devotion stabilises the mind-field
aid through īśvara-praṇidhāna ->
surrender reduces egoity
remover of the nine antarāyas
perfect model of untouched status
teacher-principle anchoring timeless
transmission and authority
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WHAT HE IS NOT (five negations)

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NOT the material cause – prakṛti remains that
NOT the Nyāya creator / efficient cause and
moral governor of the world-order
NOT a devotional saviour granting liberation
arbitrarily
NOT one of the ordinary BOUND witnesses
NOT a substitute for viveka-khyāti
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SOURCE CONTROL

PATAÑJALI'S OWN GROUNDS are compact and practice-facing: special witness · unsurpassed omniscience · timeless teacherhood · praṇava-mediated contemplation.

LATER YOGA COMMENTATORS add scripture, maximal degrees of knowledge and power, and the need for intelligent coordination of witness and nature.

! Do NOT project the full later creator / administrator proof-set back onto Patañjali.

OBJECTION (from nirīśvara Sāṃkhya) -> if the ontology already explains liberation, why add a Lord?

REPLY -> pragmatic and soteriological: a unique focus of devotion, obstacle-removal, support for absorption

OBJECTION (redundancy) -> if viveka-khyāti liberates, is he not redundant?

REPLY -> NOT redundant, but NON-FINAL.

THE FORMULA THAT ANSWERS BOTH: THE LORD IS INSTRUMENTAL, NOT CONSTITUTIVE, IN LIBERATION. This is why the school is seśvara-sāṃkhya: real theism, bounded theism.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 20/24: Isolation – the road from practice to self-abidance

abhyāsa + vairāgya

v

kriyā-yoga and aṣṭāṅga-yoga

v

attenuation and destruction of the kleśas

v

stable samādhi

v

VIVEKA-KHYĀTI – uninterrupted discernment of the ABSOLUTE DIFFERENCE between the conscious witness and primordial nature. Yoga stays COGNITIVIST at the summit: absorption is indispensable, but its function is to MATURE discernment.

v

PARA-VAIRĀGYA – no craving even for powers, experiences or exalted cognitive states. Without it, subtle egoity survives advanced practice.

v

DHARMAMEGHA-SAMĀDHI – ripened summit of perfected discipline and discernment. NOT a divine grace replacing effort.

v

+---- KAIVALYA -----+
| DEFINITION: aloneness / isolation / absolute distinctness – the isolation of the |
| witness from prakṛti and its evolutes. |
| ON NATURE'S SIDE: PRATIPRASAVA – the guṇas cease to function for that witness and |
| resolve back toward their source; citta's function is exhausted. |
| ON THE WITNESS'S SIDE: SVARŪPA-PRA TIṢṬHĀ – consciousness abides in its own nature, |
| completing the promise of YS 1.3. |
+-----+

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 21/24: Isolation – the four negations, images and contrasts

FOUR NEGATIONS (UPSC tests this term almost entirely through contrasts)

NOT union with God in the devotional sense

NOT identity with Brahman in the Advaita sense

NOT annihilation of consciousness

NOT mere painlessness abstracted from the self's own luminosity

(and NOT destruction of mind as a substance – its binding vṛttis cease)

THREE IMAGES

kṣetrika (FARMER) breaches the embankment; water flows by its own nature.

Discipline removes obstruction; it does not MAKE freedom.

DAGDHA-BĪJA destroyed kleśas keep their shape and cannot germinate.

POTTER'S WHEEL after the push stops the wheel turns until momentum is spent

=> the careful basis for jīvanmukti language.

CONTRAST GRID

YOGA KAIVALYA

many puruṣas

isolation of puruṣa from prakṛti

no Brahman-doctrine; DISENTANGLEMENT

YOGA KAIVALYA

positive isolation and self-abidance

rooted in puruṣa-prakṛti discrimination

citta resolves, puruṣa shines

ADVAITA MOKṢA

one Brahman as ultimate reality

realisation of ātman-Brahman identity

non-dual realisation; IDENTITY

NYĀYA APAVARGA

often described as cessation of pain and bondage

rooted in true knowledge of categories and self

self remains; liberation characterised negatively

! TRAP 21: the Lord assists but does NOT grant kaivalya. Liberation follows viveka-khyāti.

! TRAP 22: whether kaivalya is blissful self-abidance or austere aloneness is CONTESTED.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 22/24: The realist polemic of the isolation chapter

PŪRVAPAKṢA (vijñānavāda / yogācāra): what is taken as an external object is explicable as cognition-only; the object need not be admitted as independently real.

SIDDHĀNTA (Kaivalya-pāda realism), in four moves:

- 1 OBJECT-INDEPENDENCE an object is not EKACITTA-TANTRA (dependent on a single mind); otherwise it would vanish when that mind ceased to cognise it
- 2 THE MIND'S KNOWNNESS citta is NA TAT SVĀBHĀSAM (not self-illuminating) because it is itself DRŚYA (seen) for puruṣa; mind-only struggles to terminate the regress of cognitions cognising cognitions
- 3 NO SIMULTANEOUS SELF-COGNITION the mind cannot apprehend itself and its object in one act, as though it were both lamp and illuminated object
- 4 UPARĀGA (colouring) an object is known when citta is UPARAKTA by it; known-versus-unknown depends on citta's colouring => object is not identical with the cognition

THREE-TERM REALISM: viṣaya (object) · citta-vṛtti (modification) · puruṣa (witness)

COUNTER -> shared karmic traces explain intersubjective appearance without external objects

REJOINER-> a common object plus many cittas explains shared appearance better

RESIDUE !-> Yoga must still say HOW an external object colours an insentient citta

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 23/24: Inter-school comparison, criticisms and graded verdict

COMPARISON AXES: self · God · causation · liberation · pramāṇa count

- vs SĀṂKHYA same ontology; nirīśvara there, seśvara here; explanatory metaphysics there, practical psychology and samādhi here
- vs NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA broad citta vs atomic manas + self-substance; meditative Lord vs creator; kaivalya vs apavarga; 3 pramāṇas vs 4
- vs ADVAITA many puruṣas + real prakṛti vs non-dual Brahman; isolation vs identity-realisation
- vs BUDDHISM enduring puruṣa vs nairātmyavāda; discrimination-aimed meditation vs impermanence-aimed insight; kaivalya vs nirvāṇa

EIGHT CRITICISMS -> REPLIES

- inactive puruṣa bound? -> misidentification through reflection, not alteration
- insentient citta cognising? -> it becomes luminous by reflecting puruṣa
- restrain TRUE cognition? -> form binds, not falsity; akliṣṭa is a ladder
- asamprajñāta = sleep? -> genesis and value differ; nidrā is itself a vṛtti
- why add a Lord? -> practical efficacy, not metaphysical necessity
- is the Lord redundant? -> non-final rather than redundant
- is kaivalya merely negative? -> svarūpa-pratiṣṭhā is its positive side
- is dhyāna enough? -> no; without yama-niyama, power coexists with affliction

GRADED VERDICT

- STRONG rigorous phenomenology of mental process · integration of psychology, ethics and metaphysics · an operational path · genuine metaphysical commitment shown by the realist arguments
- WEAK the puruṣa-prakṛti interaction problem · the Lord's limited explanatory role · the contestable value of contentless pure consciousness
- CONTESTED status of ānanda and asmitā in the taxonomy · character of kaivalya · unity and layering of the sūtra tradition

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 24/24: PYQ ownership, the answer route and the qualified conclusion

PYQ OWNERSHIP AND ANSWER ROUTE (7 primary-owned parts, 2019-2025; no 2018 owner)

2019 Q7(b) 15 .. citta-levels of scientist / devotee / yogin -> PANEL 5
2020 Q5(b) 10 .. samprajñāta vs asamprajñāta -> PANELS 15, 16
2021 Q6(a) 20 .. nature of kleśas; removal leads to kaivalya -> PANELS 10-12, 20
2022 Q5(c) 10 .. nature and stages of samādhi; role of Īśvara -> PANELS 15-19
2023 Q7(c) 15 .. citta and its modifications; why cessation -> PANELS 3, 6, 7
2024 Q7(b) 15 .. reflection, misidentification, appraisal -> PANELS 4, 9, 22-24
2025 Q7(b) 15 .. nature of God and its role in kaivalya -> PANELS 19-21
ROUTED 2018 Q6(a) 20 [Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika primary] .. Nyāya vs Yoga proofs of God
-> PANELS 19, 22-24

ANSWER SPINE: define in Pātañjala terms -> classify without conflating schemes ->
give the causal pathway -> use one accurate analogy -> distinguish from Sāṃkhya, Nyāya,
Buddhism or Advaita as demanded -> state objection, reply and residual pressure ->
add the textual / commentarial caution -> conclude by relating discipline to discernment.

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION: Yoga turns Sāṃkhya's dualism into a disciplined psychology of liberation in which ethics, attention, absorption and insight progressively dismantle the causal machinery of bondage. Its account of citta and saṃskāra explains why intellectual assent alone cannot liberate. Yet reflected consciousness, the relation among the highest absorptions and the necessity of the Lord remain debated. Kaivalya therefore rests not on trance but on irreversible discrimination between the witness and every transformation of nature.